



Delaware County Commissioners Special Meeting May 8th 2020

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7eApFVvoFU0
Publication Date	2020-05-08T20:33:42Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Commissioners Special Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: Friday, May 8, 2020

Meeting Type: Special Meeting

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the Delaware County Commissioners special meeting to order at **00:00:03**. Public questions or comments regarding the meeting content were directed via email to commissioners@co.delaware.in.us.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Board Members Present:** Commissioner Reagan, Commissioner King, and Commissioner Henry (Presiding).
 - **Other Key Officials/Staff:** Dr. Wilkins (Health Department), Jason (Emergency Operations Center / EOC), John (Attorney / Clerk), Scott, Pam (Human Resources), and Jamie.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None noted in the transcript.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** None noted in the transcript.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:07:28 Emergency Declaration Extension

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** John (County Attorney / Clerk) and Board of Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed and reviewed an updated 11-point emergency declaration responding to COVID-19. Key provisions include:
 - Extending the local disaster emergency through the end of business on May 18, 2020, and adopting Governor Holcomb's Executive Order 20-26 ("Back On Track Indiana").
 - Reopening county buildings and the Justice Center starting May 11, 2020, on an appointment-only basis.
 - Mandating a strict 6-foot social distancing rule and requiring face masks for the public and employees during interactions or when moving about the buildings.
 - Setting maximum occupancy limits of no more than 25 members of the public per floor in the County Building and 25 people in the Justice Center (excluding staff, lawyers, and litigants).
 - Elevating employee mask requirements during movement and interactions.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (3-0: King - Yes, Reagan - Yes, Henry - Yes).
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00:17:20 Agreement Between Delaware County EMS and St. Vincent's Anderson

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jason (EOC).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed an agreement for medical direction and oversight for Delaware County EMS provided by St. Vincent's Ascension (Anderson). It was confirmed that St. Vincent's provides this medical direction completely free of charge, as they do for multiple counties across Indiana.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (3-0: Reagan - Yes, King - Yes, Henry - Yes).
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00:19:20 Resolution 2020-010: Voluntary County Furlough Program

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Scott and John (County Attorney / Clerk).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Prompted by the County Treasurer (Ed Carroll) looking at models from neighboring counties like Henry County, the board introduced a voluntary COVID-19 furlough program.
 - Department heads and elected officials will coordinate with staff to seek volunteers.
 - Furloughs are scheduled to run for 12 weeks starting May 14, 2020, through August 5, 2020.
 - Furloughed employees become immediately eligible for unemployment compensation, and the county will continue paying its portion of employee health insurance costs while vacation/comp time is frozen.
 - Modeled on similar programs, a target of 30 participating employees is estimated to save the county approximately \$200,000.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (3-0: King - Yes, Reagan - Yes, Henry - Yes).
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00:27:08 Resolution 2020-M9: Continuity of Services and Staggered Schedules

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** John (County Attorney / Clerk).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** This resolution amends previous policies regarding remote work time, on-call pay, and staggered schedules (affecting departments such as the highway department) to work in conjunction with the new furlough program and continued operational adjustments.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Correction/Roll Call recorded: Reagan - Yes, King - Yes, Henry - Yes).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

Note: No dedicated open floor citizen forum period was held during this special meeting, though officials noted that residents could submit questions via email to commissioners@co.delaware.in.us.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Health Update (00:00:48):** Dr. Wilkins reported 220 positive COVID-19 cases and 20 deaths in Delaware County, noting a slight slowdown in positive results. Testing at the National Guard Armory (via Optum) has expanded criteria to include individuals over 65 and high-risk individuals (those with diabetes, obesity,

hypertension, kidney/lung disease, or African-American demographics) without requiring symptoms. Testing is free, though insurance cards are requested.

- **EOC & PPE Update (00:03:19):** Jason reported that the EOC continues sourcing PPE for local churches, doctors, and dentists. FEMA PPE public safety allocations arrived for first responders (police/fire), though quantities were described as modest (e.g., 195 N95 masks county-wide distributed across 18 departments). State public assistance webinars for government agencies and nonprofits are scheduled for May 12.
- **Hospitalization Update (00:15:46):** Jamie reported a promising local statistic of only 3 active hospitalizations out of total COVID-19 cases in Delaware County.
- **Property Tax Payments (00:28:42):** Commissioners reminded residents that property tax drop boxes are available in front of the County Building, and certain banks are accepting payments. Property taxes are formally due May 11, but the state/Governor has granted a grace period waiving late penalties through July 10, 2020 (including special assessments like ditch fees).
- **Next Meeting:** The next regular commissioners' meeting is scheduled for Monday, May 18, 2020, at 9:00 AM via the Zoom platform due to the state emergency declaration remaining active through June 4.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was recessed/adjourned following a roll call vote (King - Yes, Reagan - Yes, Henry - Yes).